This Spanish soup is seriously garlicky, but heavenly in summer. You could reduce the number of garlic cloves to as few as two—if you wish.

white gazpacho

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

3oz (85g) white bread (crusts removed), cut into cubes
2 cups ice water
9oz (250g) whole blanched almonds
6 garlic cloves, coarsely chopped
3 tbsp olive oil
3 tbsp sherry vinegar or white balsamic vinegar
salt and freshly ground black pepper
5½oz (150g) seedless white grapes

1 Soak the bread in all but 3 tbsp of the ice water for 10 minutes. Meanwhile, place the almonds in a food processor and process until ground as finely as possible. Add the remaining 3 tbsp ice water and blend to a paste. Remove the bread from the water (reserving the water) and add to the processor, along with the garlic, and blend again.

2 With the motor running, gradually add the water the bread soaked in, followed by the oil. Keep pulsing until the mixture is absolutely smooth. Add the vinegar and season to taste with salt and freshly ground black pepper. To serve, place a handful of grapes in the bottom of each bowl, ladle the soup on top, then drizzle with a little olive oil, if desired.